CalWORKs Program Guide: A. Residence

COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO HEALTH & HUMAN SERVICES AGENCY - CALWORKS PROGRAM GUIDE

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Section 1

COUNTY OF SAN DIEGO HEALTH AND HUMAN SERVICES AGENCY
CALWORKS PROGRAM GUIDE ? SECTION 42-400: RESIDENCE REQUIREMENTS
TITLE: A. RESIDENCE AND INTENT TO RESIDE IN CALIFORNIA

Section 2

1. POLICY BACKGROUND & PURPOSE
In accordance with California Welfare and Institutions Code Section 11100 and CDSS MPP EAS 42-400, an applicant or recipient must be a resident of the State of California and reside within San Diego County to establish and maintain eligibility for CalWORKs cash assistance.

Section 3

2. DETAILED REGULATORY STANDARDS & RESIDENCY RULES
? Definition of California Residency: A person is a California resident if they are physically present in the state and have the intention to remain in California permanently or indefinitely, or entered the state with a job commitment or seeking employment.
? No Durational Residency Requirement: California imposes no waiting period or minimum length of time that a family must live in the state before applying for CalWORKs. Eligibility begins the date physical presence and intent are established.
? Homeless Households: Individuals and families experiencing homelessness meet residency requirements if they are physically present in San Diego County and state their intent to remain. A permanent street address is never required.
? Temporary Absence: A recipient remains eligible during a temporary absence from California of up to 30 consecutive calendar days, provided they maintain their California residence and intend to return.
? I nter-County Transfers (ICT): When a family moves from San Diego County to another California county, San Diego continues payment for the transfer period while the receiving county completes the transfer without interrupting aid.

Section 4

3. CASEWORKER OPERATING PROCEDURES & VERIFICATION CHECKLIST
? Acceptable Verifications: Rental agreements, utility bills, mail, school records, or a signed statement under penalty of perjury (for unhoused families) establish residency.

? Electronic Check: Review cross-state electronic benefit match reports (PARIS match) to verify the customer is not receiving duplicate cash benefits from another state.

? I CT Initiation: When a client reports moving to another California county, initiate the automated Inter-County Transfer within 7 business days.